

Felix Saaro

Software Engineer, MSc Data Science
Zurich, Switzerland

felix@saaro.ch
felix.saaro.ch
github.com/MrF3lix
linkedin.com/in/felix-saaro

Software Engineer who builds things end-to-end. From multi-node GPU clusters to the web and mobile apps. I got into engineering the same way I got into sailing: I wanted to understand how the whole system works, not just my corner of it. That instinct has taken me from DevOps pipelines and front-end components to deploying LLMs on on-premise infrastructure and building multimodal perception systems in research. Whether I'm reading a weather chart on open water or tracing a bug through a distributed system, I'm most comfortable when I can see the full picture.

Skills & Languages

ML/AI	PyTorch, PEFT, vLLM and NVIDIA Triton, Computer Vision (Event Camera & LiDAR)
Data	Prodigy, Sensor Simulation, PostgreSQL, SLURM
Programming	Python, React, React-Native, .NET, Node.js
Infrastructure	Docker, Kubernetes, CI & CD in Azure DevOps and GitHub
Languages	German (Fluent, Native), English (Fluent, C1)

Experience

Research Assistant — ZHAW, Centre for Artificial Intelligence 2023 – Present
Winterthur, Switzerland

Built and deployed infrastructure for running multiple **LLMs up to 70B parameters** simultaneous on on-premise multi-node GPU clusters using NVIDIA Triton and vLLM.

Designed and implemented a **multimodal perception pipeline** combining event cameras and LiDAR for real-time aerial object detection. Developed a **synthetic dataset generation pipeline** using simulation to accelerate model training and evaluation.

Led end-to-end development of an **LLM-assisted labeling system** extracting **574 hierarchical labels** from **30k medical records** using only **2k annotated samples**.

Responsible for full ML lifecycle: data preparation, annotation strategy, model fine-tuning, evaluation, and stakeholder reporting. Built internal tools for autonomous testing infrastructure (React, Node.js, PostgreSQL) used to coordinate experiments and sensor validation.

DevOps Engineer — Bühler Group AG 2019 – 2023
Uzwil, Switzerland

Built automation across Azure DevOps pipelines improving code review workflows, dependency tracking, and release processes across multiple teams. Developed an internal **documentation platform indexing 100 repositories** with integrated chatbot search using Azure Bot Framework. Prototyped an early **RAG system** using FastAPI and PostgreSQL to enable semantic search across engineering documentation. Contributed to infrastructure and process improvements supporting **ISO27001 certification**. Helped standardize shared frontend components within an Angular library used across multiple products.

Front-End Engineer — CanvasHeroes B.V. 2017 – 2019
Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Led development of multiple web and mobile applications using React, React Native, and Symfony. Improved scalability of a production application to support **10k concurrent users** through caching and distributed database replication. Implemented CI/CD pipelines using Bitbucket, improving deployment reliability and release speed. Mentored interns through code reviews and engineering best practices.

Apprentice / Software Developer — Online Consulting AG 2013 – 2017
Wil, Switzerland

Contributed to a web-based platform for industrial after-sales services within an international SCRUM team.

Education

MSc Data Science – ZHAW in Winterthur, Switzerland	2023 – Present
Thesis: On the Evaluation of RAG Systems: A Bayesian View	<i>Final Grade: WIP</i>
Semester Project: Do NOT Classify and Count: Hybrid Attribute Control Success Evaluation	<i>Final Grade: 6/6</i>
BSc Computer Science – ZHAW in Winterthur, Switzerland	2020 – 2023
Including an Exchange Semester at UiA in Grimstad, Norway	Fall 2022
Thesis: The Influence of Audio Length on the Performance of Swiss-German Speech Translation Models	<i>Final Grade: 5.5/6</i>

Projects

Skäirim - Swiss-German Voice Mod for Skyrim

Ongoing

A mod that localizes dialogue by cloning character voices using a fine-tuned Qwen3-TTS model conditioned on character race. Using 8,000 hours (3.5 TB) of speech across seven dialects and trained using multi-GPU pipelines (PyTorch DataParallel).

Cheers.li

2023

Mobile app to share your location with friends and invite them to join. Built with Capacitor and Supabase, deployed via Fastlane.

Flooq.io

2022

Event-driven low-code platform connecting software systems. Built with React, .NET, and NodeJS, deployed on Kubernetes using Helm Charts.

Volunteer Experience

President – Handballclub Uzwil

2024 – Present

Lead a club with 100 children across 14 teams and 60 adults across three teams. Coordinate activities, support coaches and volunteers, and organize initiatives such as two regional youth tournaments with 400 participants each.